

Bowen Yi

Ph.D. Student in Computer Science, University of Southern California

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Research Interests

Human-centered NLP; multimodal AI; AI for health; computational social science.

Education

Aug. 2025 Present	University of Southern California Ph.D. in Computer Science • GPA: 3.90/4.00 Advisor: Shrikanth Narayanan	Los Angeles, CA
Jan. 2023 May. 2025	University of Michigan, Ann Arbor B.S. in Computer Science • GPA: 3.79/4.00	Ann Arbor, MI
Sep. 2021 Dec. 2022	University of California, San Diego (Transferred) B.S. in Mathematics–Computer Science • GPA: 3.83/4.00	La Jolla, CA

Publications and Manuscripts

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- [1] **Tracing Moral Foundations in Large Language Models** [\[paper\]](#)
Chenxiao Yu*, **Bowen Yi***, Farzan Karimi-Malekabadi, Suhaib Abdurahman, Jinyi Ye, Shrikanth Narayanan, Yue Zhao, Morteza Dehghani
NeurIPS 2026 (Main Track)
- [2] **Towards Interpretable Framework for Neural Audio Codecs via Sparse Autoencoders: A Case Study on Accent Information**
Shih-Heng Wang, Tiantian Feng, Aditya Kommineni, Thanathai Lertpetchpun, **Bowen Yi**, Xuan Shi, Shrikanth Narayanan
Interspeech 2026
- [3] **AI-Augmented Counselor Training for Reflective Listening in Resource-Limited Settings: A Field Study in Honduras**
Longju Bai, John Piette, Do June Min, Darlin Mancia, **Bowen Yi**, Rafael Mejía Perdomo, Ernesto Gálvez-Pineda, Rada Mihalcea, Verónica Pérez-Rosas
ACII 2026
- [4] **Real or Robotic? Assessing Whether LLMs Accurately Simulate Qualities of Human Responses in Dialogue** [\[paper\]](#)
Jonathan Ivey*, ..., **Bowen Yi***, ..., David Jurgens
Findings of ACL 2026
- [5] **NLP for Social Good: A Survey of Challenges, Opportunities and Responsible Deployment** [\[paper\]](#)
Antonia Karamolegkou, ..., **Bowen Yi**, ..., Daryna Dementieva
EACL 2026 (Oral)
- [6] **Examining Spanish Counseling with MIDAS: a Motivational Interviewing Dataset in Spanish** [\[paper\]](#)
Aylin Gunal*, **Bowen Yi***, John Piette, Rada Mihalcea, Verónica Pérez-Rosas
NAACL 2025
- [7] **Causally Modeling the Linguistic and Social Factors that Predict Email Response** [\[paper\]](#)
Yinuo Xu*, ..., **Bowen Yi***, ..., David Jurgens
NAACL 2025
- [8] **The Generation Gap: Exploring Age Bias Underlying in the Value Systems of Large Language Models** [\[paper\]](#)
Siyang Liu, Trish Maturi, **Bowen Yi**, Siqi Shen, Rada Mihalcea
EMNLP 2024

Manuscripts Under Review and Preprints

- [9] **Last Translation Benchmark** [\[paper\]](#)
Vilém Zouhar, ..., **Bowen Yi**, ..., Zaid Alyafeai
arXiv preprint
- [10] **De-conflating Preference and Qualification: Constrained Dual-Perspective Reasoning for Job Recommendation with Large Language Models** [\[paper\]](#)
Bryce Kan, Wei Yang, Emily Nguyen, Ganghui Yi, **Bowen Yi**, Chenxiao Yu, Yan Liu
arXiv preprint

* Equal contribution; author order is randomized where specified by the paper.

Academic Service

Reviewer: EMNLP 2025; ACL 2026; NeurIPS 2026; ACII 2026; GenAI4Health @ NeurIPS 2025 and 2026; ACL Rolling Review

Industry Experience

Software Engineering Intern | BoardX  Jun. 2023–Aug. 2023

Mentor: Feng Zhang

- > Built features for a collaborative digital whiteboard, including Azure-backed data management, AI-assisted ideation, and color-blind-friendly interface elements.

Selected Presentations

- > “Examining Spanish Counseling with MIDAS.” [NAACL 2025](#), Albuquerque, NM; MSLD 2025, Notre Dame, IN. [\[poster\]](#)
- > “Causally Modeling the Linguistic and Social Factors that Predict Email Response.” [NAACL 2025](#), Albuquerque, NM. [\[poster\]](#)
- > “NLP for Enhanced Behavioral Counseling in Spanish.” EMNLP 2024 BoF on Large Multimodal Models for Biomedical Research; Michigan AI Symposium; e-HAIL Symposium.
- > “Can LLMs Simulate Human Subject Studies?” NLP Reading Group, Michigan AI Lab, September 2024. [\[slides\]](#)

Honors and Awards

Center for Computational Language Sciences (CCLS) Seed Funding, 2026 | University of Southern California [\[🔗\]](#)

Viterbi School of Engineering Fellowship, 2025–2026 | University of Southern California [\[🔗\]](#)

James B. Angell Scholar, 2025 | University of Michigan [\[🔗\]](#)

University Honors, 2023–2025 | University of Michigan [\[🔗\]](#)

IEEE-Eta Kappa Nu, 2022 & 2024 | UC San Diego & University of Michigan [\[🔗\]](#)

Provost Honors, 2021–2022 | UC San Diego [\[🔗\]](#)

Teaching and Leadership

Grader, EECS 486: Information Retrieval | University of Michigan Jan. 2025–Apr. 2025

- > Graded programming assignments, exams, and final projects and provided detailed feedback to more than 100 students.

NLP Reading Group | University of Michigan *Co-Organizer* [\[🔗\]](#) Sep. 2024–Apr. 2025

- > Co-organized weekly research presentations and grew an interdisciplinary community of 180 members across computing, medicine, and psychology.

Volunteer College-Application Mentor Oct. 2021–Mar. 2023

- > Mentored approximately 10 financially disadvantaged domestic and international students on first-year and transfer applications.

Skills

Machine Learning	PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face Transformers, scikit-learn
Programming	Python, C/C++, Java, HTML/CSS
Languages	Hunanese and Mandarin (native), English (fluent)